

VIKING NPCs

Vikings is a monster supplement for 5e that presents Vikings as a structured, escalating threat rather than a handful of interchangeable axe-wielding raiders. Instead of relying on a single generic Viking stat block, this book provides a full ladder of Viking roles—from children, common folk, and reckless youths to disciplined shieldbearers, berserkers, ritual seers, jarls, and warlords—each designed to fill a distinct function during play.

The intent of this product is encounter control and tactical variety. Each Viking type supports a specific style of engagement: formation fighting, shock assaults, momentum pressure, morale and leadership, ritual support, or decisive command. Allegiances, faiths, and destinations are intentionally undefined, allowing these stat blocks to represent raiders, settlers, mercenaries, explorers, or conquering warbands. These Vikings are tools of violence, cohesion, and ambition—who they follow, what shores they strike, and what sagas they seek to carve into history is left entirely in the GM's hands.

VIKING LADDER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Viking Child	0	Noncombatant youth raised within the clan. Harm to a child often provokes immediate and violent retaliation from nearby Vikings.
Viking Commoner	0	Farmer, fisher, or craftsperson hardened by labor but untrained for war, armed only with tools or a simple axe when pressed.
Viking Youth	1/8	Adolescents eager to earn honor and reputation, reckless in battle and dangerous when emboldened by allies.
Viking Thrall	1/8	Enslaved laborer or captive forced into combat, poorly equipped and driven by fear rather than loyalty.
Viking Warrior	1/4	Standard clan fighter armed with axe, spear, and shield, trained to fight in close formation and support allies.
Viking Shieldbearer	1/2	Disciplined frontline defender who anchors shield walls, protects allies, and holds ground under pressure.
Viking Raider	1	Aggressive shock trooper trained for coastal assaults and boarding actions, built to break lines and exploit momentum.
Viking Scout	1	Lightly equipped outrider skilled in terrain, stealth, and pursuit, used to guide warbands and harass enemies before battle.
Viking Berserker	2	Frenzied warrior who fights through pain and fear, trading defense for overwhelming violence and relentless pressure.
Viking Huscarl	3	Elite household guard sworn to a leader, disciplined, heavily trusted, and deadly in close formation.
Viking Rune Seer	4	Ritual mystic who shapes battle through omens, runes, and restrained magic focused on control and morale.
Viking Champion	5	Renowned hero of the clan whose presence inspires allies and turns the tide through superior skill and endurance.
Viking Jarl	6	Clan leader and battlefield commander who directs warriors through authority, tactics, and personal reputation.
Viking Skald-Seer	7	Saga-singer and prophet whose chants and curses influence fate itself, bolstering allies and unraveling foes.
Viking Warlord	8	Supreme leader of a great warband whose command transforms raids into full-scale campaigns and decisive battles.

IMAGES

Images are included for both male and female Vikings for each entry.

VIKING YOUTH

VIKING YOUTH

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 14 (leather, shield)

Hit Points 13 (3d8)

Speed 30 ft., swim 15 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	9 (−1)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Athletics +3, Intimidation +2

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common, Nordic

Challenge 1/8 (25 XP)

Seafarer.

This Viking has proficiency with water vehicles and has advantage on ability checks made to board, balance, or fight while aboard a boat or ship.

Eager for Glory.

This Viking has advantage on its first attack roll on its turn if at least one allied Viking can see this Viking and is within 10 feet of the target.

Reckless Charge.

At the start of this Viking's turn, it may choose to gain advantage on all melee attack rolls it makes during that turn. Until the start of its next turn, attack rolls against this Viking have advantage.

ACTIONS:

Hand Axe. *Melee Attack or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) slashing damage.

Shield Bash. *Strength Saving Throw:* DC 11. On fail take 3 (1d4+1) bludgeoning damage and if the target is Medium or smaller it falls Prone.

REACTIONS:

Follow My Lead.

When an allied Viking within 5 feet of this Viking hits a creature with a melee attack, this Viking may move up to 10 feet toward that creature without provoking opportunity attacks.

- Reckless and eager to prove themselves.
- Overcommit, chase wounded foes, and fall for feints.
- Excellent early warning that a real warband is nearby.



VIKING SHIELDBEARER

VIKING SHIELDBEARER

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 14 (leather, shield)

Hit Points 33 (6d8 + 6)

Speed 30 ft., swim 15 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)

Skills Athletics +4, Perception +3

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common, Nordic

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Seafarer. This Viking has proficiency with water vehicles and has advantage on ability checks made to keep footing, brace impacts, or hold formation aboard a boat or ship.

Shield Wall Expert. While this Viking is within 5 feet of at least one allied Viking wielding a shield and not incapacitated, this Viking gains a +2 bonus to Armor Class.

Stand Fast. This Viking has advantage on Strength and Constitution saving throws made to resist being knocked prone, pushed, or moved against its will.

ACTIONS

Hand Axe. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) slashing damage.

Shield Bash. *Strength Saving Throw:* DC 12. On fail take 9 (2d4 + 2) bludgeoning damage and if the target is Medium or smaller it falls Prone.

REACTIONS

Intercept Blow. When an allied Viking within 5 feet of this Viking is hit by a melee attack, this Viking may use its reaction to impose disadvantage on that attack roll.

Hold the Line. Creatures provoke opportunity attacks from this Viking even if they take the Disengage action, provided they move out of a space within 5 feet of this Viking.

- Anchor points for formations and chokepoints.
- Prioritize protecting leaders and holding ground over killing.
- Dangerous in tight spaces like ship decks, bridges, and doorways.



VIKING BERSERKER

VIKING BERSERKER

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 13 (studded leather)

Hit Points 67 (9d8 + 27)

Speed 30 ft., swim 15 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	9 (–1)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)

Skills Athletics +6, Intimidation +3

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common, Nordic

Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Seafarer. This Viking has proficiency with water vehicles and has advantage on ability checks made to fight, brace, or remain standing aboard a boat or ship.

Battle Frenzy. At the start of this Viking's turn, it may enter a frenzy (no action required). While frenzied, this Viking has advantage on Strength-based attack rolls and Strength saving throws, and it gains resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks. The frenzy ends early if this Viking is incapacitated.

Reckless Onslaught. While frenzied, attack rolls against this Viking have advantage.

Blood for Blood. When this Viking reduces a creature to 0 hit points, this Viking may immediately move up to 10 feet and make one melee weapon attack as part of the same turn.

Fearless. This Viking has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

ACTIONS

Great Axe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (1d12 + 4) slashing damage.

Throwing Axe. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 3) slashing damage.

REACTIONS

Savage Retaliation. When this Viking takes damage from a creature within 5 feet, this Viking may make one melee weapon attack against that creature.

- Unleashed weapons, not commanders.
- Point them at the enemy and let them go.
- Their deaths should feel costly but inevitable.



VIKING SKALD-SEER

VIKING SKALD-SEER

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 16 (ritual leather)

Hit Points 126 (19d8 + 38)

Speed 30 ft., swim 15 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Wis +7, Cha +7

Skills History +5, Insight +7, Perception +7, Performance +7, Religion +5

Senses passive Perception 17

Languages Common, Nordic, one other

Challenge 7 (2,900 XP)

Seafarer.

This Viking has proficiency with water vehicles and has advantage on ability checks made to chant, sing, or maintain ritual focus aboard a boat or ship.

Words of Fate.

At the start of each of this Viking's turns, choose one creature this Viking can see within 30 feet.

- If the creature is an enemy, it has disadvantage on its first attack roll made before the start of this Viking's next turn.
- If the creature is an allied Viking, it gains advantage on its first attack roll made before the start of this Viking's next turn.

Saga-Song.

While this Viking is conscious, allied Vikings within 30 feet that can hear this Viking gain advantage on saving throws against being frightened and charmed.

Spellcasting. The Viking Skald-Seer is a 8th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). It has the following spells prepared:

- **At will:** [guidance](#), [thaumaturgy](#), [vicious mockery](#).
- **1st level (4 slots):** [bane](#), [bless](#), [command](#)
- **2nd level (3 slots):** [calm emotions](#), [hold person](#), [silence](#)
- **3rd level (3 slots):** [bestow curse](#), [fear](#)
- **4th level (3 slots):** [blight](#), [compulsion](#)

ACTIONS:

Rune-Staff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

REACTIONS:

Foretold Doom.

When a creature this Viking can see within 30 feet succeeds on an attack roll or saving throw, this Viking may force that creature to reroll the d20 and use the lower result.

- Myth-makers and fate-weavers.
- Influence the battle even when not directly attacking.
- Killing one should feel like silencing a living saga.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

[Viking Village](#): A full set of maps needed for Viking encounters and adventures.

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